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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BANDAGE, GAUZE, (ROLLER AND COMPRESSED)

This specification was approved by the Comissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers gauze bandages, roller and compressed, for use in treatment of injuries of multiple types.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, classes, and sizes. Gauze bandages shall be of the following types, classes, and sizes, as specified (see 6.1).

Type I - Roller.
Type II - Compressed.
Classes
  1 - Plain
  2 - Camouflaged
Sizes
  a - 1 inch by 6 yards
  b - 1 inch by 10 yards
  c - 2 inches by 6 yards
  d - 2 inches by 10 yards
  e - 3 inches by 6 yards
  f - 3 inches by 10 yards
  g - 4 inches by 6 yards
  h - 4 inches by 10 yards

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

FF-P-416 - Pins, Safety.
CCC-G-101 - Gauze, Absorbent.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.
PPP-T-76 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive, Adhesive Paper, for Carton Sealing.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

FSC 6510

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U.S. Pharmacopeia Convention, Inc.

Pharmacopeia of the United States (U.S.P.)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Printing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Gauze shall conform in all applicable respects to the requirements for type I of CCC-G-101, except that camouflaged bandages need not be bleached before dyeing.

3.2 Description. Each bandage shall be one continuous piece having no tranverse cuts along its outer edges. Bandages shall be tightly and evenly rolled, and substantially free from loose threads, cotton dust, and ravelings. The cut edges of each bandage shall be crushed during cutting to form a substantially ravel free edge from which no continuous thread longer than 8 inches can be raveled. Type II, sizes g and h, shall be supplied with two large safety pins conforming to size 3 of FF-P-416.

3.3 Sterilization. Unless otherwise specified, the bandage shall be sterile when tested as specified in 4.2.4.2. Each wrapped bandage shall be sterilized by steam sterilization.

3.3.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer charge have been tested as specified in 4.2.4.2 and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

(a) Item identification.
(b) Federal stock number.
(c) Contract or purchase order number.
(d) Lot or control number, which also reflects sterilization.
(e) Date of sterilization.
(f) Method of sterilization.
(g) Date sterility test was started and completed.
(h) Specific test method used and results.
(i) Statement that samples comply (or do not comply) with sterility test selected.
(j) Signature of head of laboratory or a designated alternate, qualified in the testing performed.
(k) Quantity in sterilizer load.

3.3.2 When inspection is made at destination, the certifiate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the procuring activity, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to consignee. When inspection is made at source, the certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government quality assurance representative, for submission to the procuring activity.

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3.3.3 Shipment of contract material. Shipment of contract material may be made upon presenting a certificate of sterilization to the quality assurance representative. The certificate of sterilization shall contain the identical information required in subparagraphs (a), (b), (c), (d), (e), (f), and (k) of 3.3.1. Within two weeks after the date of shipment, the contractor shall advise the procuring activity if the test representing material shipped shows failure in sterility testing. This should be done by telephone, TWX, or other immediate means. The contractor shall accept and be financially responsible for the return of all nonsterile material. Not later than one month after the shipment date of the contract material, a Certificate of Sterility shall be forwarded to the procuring activity to supplement the Certificate of Sterilization. Complete records, which shall include the gauge pressure and temperature readings, shall be maintained by the contractor for a period not less than two years from the date of delivery of the contract material to the Government. These records shall be made available to the Government upon request. The Government reserves the right to test such product material for sterility.

3.4 Class 2, camouflaged. When material is specified to be dyed to conform to the camouflaged program, it shall meet the requirements of the paragraph on "Color" in CCC-G-101. The gauze shall be dyed with 0.125 percent pontamine brown B.T.

3.5 Tolerances.

3.5.1 Length. Each bandage shall have a length tolerance of plus or minus 2 percent, when tested as specified in 4.2.2.1.1.

3.5.2 Width. Each bandage shall have a width tolerance of plus or minus 1/8 inch, when tested as specified in 4.2.2.1.2.

3.6 Compression. Each type II bandage, of the size specified, shall be compressed sufficiently to conform within a tolerance of plus or minus 1/8 inch to the following measurements:

Size a - 1 by 1-1/2 by 1/2 inches.
Size c - 2 by 1-1/2 by 1/2 inches.
Size e - 3 by 1-1/2 by 1/2 inches.

3.7 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class in every respect. Bandages and safety pins shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may use his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified herein.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, or modified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 Examination of end item. The finished bandage shall be examined for visual and dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bandage. The inspection level shall be S-4 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality levels shall be 1.0 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects, expressed in defects per hundred units (DHU). The defects found during this examination shall be classified as shown in Table I.

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TABLE I. Classification of defects

Defects	Major	Minor
Bandage not one continuous piece.	X	
Bandage not free of foreign matter.	X	
Bandage not clean (not free of loose threads, raveling or lint).	X	
Bandage not tightly and evenly rolled.	X	
Bandage not type, class, and size specified.		X
Cut edges not crushed as specified.	X	
Bandage width not within tolerance specified.	X	
Bandage length not within tolerance specified.		X
Bandage not bleached or dyed as specified.	X	

4.2.2.1 Bandage dimensions.

4.2.2.1.1 Length. The bandage length shall be determined in accordance with method 5010 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191.

4.2.2.1.2 Width. The bandage width shall be determined in accordance with method 5020 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191.

4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed snall be examined on shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size, shall be the number of shipping containers in the end items inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate strapping, or distortion of container, or quantity in containers not in accordance with Table II.

4.2.4 Tests. Except for sterility the sample unit shall be two bandages. The lot size shall be expressed in number of bandages. The inspection level shall be S-2 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. For sterility tests, the sample size shall be as described under sterility tests for liquids and suspensions in the Pharmacopeia of the United States. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet the test requirements.

4.2.4.1 Breaking strength. The breaking strength of the gauze shall be tested as specified in CCC-G-101, except the warp breaking strength shall be determined on the finished bandage on all sizes exceeding one inch width.

4.2.4.2 Sterility tests. The sterility test shall be performed as described under sterility tests for gauze and surgical dressings in the current revision of the U.S.P. or as described in 4.2.4.2.1.

4.2.4.2.1 An acceptable alternate to testing the product for sterility as provided for in the U.S.P., is to test a minimum of ten product samples, each of which has been inoculated with a minimum of one million spores of Bacillus stearothermophilus which contains a colored stain that will identify the inoculated area of the sample product. Spores shall be located within the product where the material is most dense and most inaccessible to steam penetration. The ten inoculated samples shall be distinctively marked for identification and shall be located in the sterilizer load at points including

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the lowest and highest temperatures as determined from the temperature profile study for the product. The spores shall have been previously standardized for heat resistance to have survival after exposure at 250°F. and 15 pounds per square inch (psi) saturated steam for a minimum of 5 minutes. Upon completion of the sterilization cycle of the product, the following test procedure shall be followed:

1. The samples shall be taken into the aseptic transfer room and placed under the vertical laminar flow hood. The contaminated product sample shall then be aseptically transferred to a container of Trypticase Soy Broth with Brom Cresol Purple indicator.

2. A non-processed control shall be similarly treated to ascertain the viability of the test organism and insure that the test conditions will support growth.

3. Each container, identified according to the sterilization batch number shall be incubated at 50-60°C. for 48 hours.

4. The containers shall then be removed from the incubator and examined for the presence of microbial growth as evidenced by turbidity and/or color change from purple to yellow.

5. If growth is observed in any of the ten containers, the product shall be rejected and must be resterilized. In this instance, steps 7, 8, and 9 are not performed.

6. If no growth is observed in any of the ten containers but is observed in the unprocessed control, then the product shall be released as sterile.

7. The samples shall then be incubated at 50-60°C. for an additional 5 days.

8. The samples shall be examined again for microbial growth.

9. If growth is observed in any of the ten containers, then the product shall be rejected and must be recalled for resterilization.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 General.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. The number of bandages specified in column 2 of table II constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Quantities. Packaging quantities shall be as specified in table II, except for commercial use.

TABLE II. Packaging quantities

Type, class, and size	Number of bandages constituting one unit of issue	Unit package	Intermediate package	Protective package	Shipping container
Column 1	Column 2	Column 3 (units)	Column 4 (units)	Column 5 (units)	Column 6 (units)
Type I, class 1, size a	12	1	not required	12	144
Type I, class 1, size c	12	1	not required	12	72
Type I, class 1, size f	12	1	not required	12	48
Type I, class 1, size h	12	1	not required	12	24
Type I, class 2, size c	12	1	not required	12	72
Type,I, class 2, size f	12	1	not required	12	48
Type II, class 2, size a	1	1	12	576	2,304
Type II, class 2, size c	1	1	12	576	1,152
Type II, class 2, size e	1	1	12	432	864
Type II, class 2, size g	1	1	12	240	480

5.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Unit package.

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5.2.1.1.1 Wrapper. Each type I bandage shall be individually wrapped in a good quality paper. Wrapper shall be secured by folding or other suitable means. Each type II bandage shall be individually wrapped and sealed in a good quality paper.

5.2.1.1.2 Bag (applicable to type I, class 2 and type II, class 2). Each wrapped bandage shall be packaged in a bag fabricated of polyethylene tubing having an average wall thickness of not less than 0.004 inch with no wall thickness at any point below 0.00325 inch. The two large safety pins supplied with type II, size g bandage, shall be placed in a kraft or other suitable type envelope and the envelope placed within the polyethylene bag. Excess air shall be expelled or evacuated and closure effected by heat sealing. The complete individual package shall be adequate to maintain sterility in accordance with the requirements of the U.S.P.

5.2.1.1.3 Individual carton (applicable to type I, class 1 only). Each wrapped bandage shall be enclosed and sealed in a carton of suitable size and design. The complete individual package shall be adequate to maintain sterility in accordance with the requirements of the U.S.P.

5.2.1.1.4 Unit carton.

5.2.1.1.4.1 Applicable to type I, classes 1 and 2. Each unit (12 bandages) shall be packaged in a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except that commercial colors shall be acceptable. As an alternate, style of carton shall be a one-piece folder with tuck-type closure with thumb-hole cut out on closure side. Closure shall be adequate to prevent spillage of contents under normal handling.

5.2.1.2 Intermediate package (applicable to type II, class 2 only). The number of units shown in column 4 of table II shall be intermediate packaged in a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except that commercial colors shall be acceptable. Closure shall be adequate to prevent spillage of contents under normal handling.

5.2.1.3 Protective package. The number of units shown in column 5 of table II shall be packaged in a protective package which shall be a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grades W5c or W5s. Center seams of the box shall be sealed with tape conforming to the requirements of PPP-T-76. The tape shall be not less than 2 inches wide and shall extend not less than 3 inches onto each of the end panels.

5.2.2 Level B. Packaging shall be as specified in 5.2.1.1 through 5.2.1.3, except that the box described in 5.2.1.3 shall be class domestic.

5.2.3 Level C. The bandages shall be packaged to afford protection against damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.1 Level A. The number of packaged units shown in column 6 of table II shall be packed in a fiberboard box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c or V3s. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix thereto, except that strapping will not be required.

5.3.2 Level B. The number of packaged units shown in column 6 of table II shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with method I of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.3.3 Level C. The bandage shall be packed tc insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3.4 General. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified in table II to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design as specified for the particular level of packing.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Wrapper. Marking is not required on wrapper of type I, class 1 bandages. Each wrapper except type I, class 1 shall be marked with a sterility clause and name of manufacturer.

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5.4.2 Bag. Each bag shall bear a statement to the effect that the sterility of the bandages cannot be quaranteed if the package bears evidence of damage or if the package has been previsouly opened.

5.4.2.1 Applicable to type II, class 2. Each bag shall be marked with the stock number, item identification, unit, quantity, lot (control) number, and name of contractor. When contractor is not the manufacturer, name of manufacturer shall also appear. Marking shall include the level of packaging, date packaged, and method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization). Example "A-9/69-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date. The required information shall be printed directly on the bag or on a label inserted within the bag in such a manner as to permit ready identification.

5.4.2.2 Applicable to type I, class 2. Each bag shall be marked to show contents, size, lot (control) number, "Sterile", and name of contractor. When contractor is not the manufacturer, name of manufacturer shall also appear. The required information shall be printed directly on the bag or on a label inserted within the bag in such a manner as to permit ready identification.

5.4.3 Individual carton (applicable to type I, class 1). Each individual carton shall be marked to show contents, size, lot (control) number, name of contractor, and the word "STERILE". When the contractor is not the manufacturer, name of manufacturer shall also appear. Each carton shall bear a statement to the effect that the sterility of the bandage cannot be guaranteed if the package bears evidence of damage or if the package has been previously opened.

5.4.4 Unit carton.

5.4.4.1 Applicable to type I, classes 1 and 2. Each unit carton shall be marked with the stock number, item identification, unit, quantity, and name of contractor. When contractor is not the manufacturer, name of manufacturer shall also appear. In addition, marking shall include the lot (control) number, level of packaging, date packed and method of sterilization as specified in 5.4.2.1.

5.4.5 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked with stock number, item identification, unit quantity, contract number, name of contractor, lot (control) number, level of packaging, date packed and method of sterilization as specified in 5.4.2.1.

5.4.6 Protective package.

5.4.6.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the protective package shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.6.2 Military activities. Each protective package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated from water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of the contractor shall be shown. Marking shall include the lot (control) number and method of sterilization as specified in 5.4.2.1.

5.4.7 Shipping container.

5.4.7.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.7.2 Military activities. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number and method of sterilization as specified in 5.4.2.1 shall be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, and size required (see 1.2).
(c) When nonsterile bandage is acceptable (see 3.3).
(d) When certificate of sterility is not required (see 3.3.1).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see section 5).

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6.2 This specification does not include all types, classes, and sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Review activity:

Defense Supply Agency - DM

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